

West Point Scavenger Hunt

Short Route

Tunnel, statues, the Great Chain, a hidden prize, and the big view.

9 stops · about **0.9 miles** · about **45 minutes** with stops

Follow rhyming clues from Eisenhower Hall to Trophy Point. Swipe one page at a time: read the clue, walk to the next stop, then turn the page to see what you found.

Prefer tapping? Open the [interactive web version](#).

Route preview

Mostly flat sidewalks and paths. The tunnel has a short set of stairs.

S. Start: Eisenhower Hall (park here)

- 1.** Cannons by the Firstie Club · 4 min walk
- 2.** Beat Navy Tunnel · 3 min walk
- 3.** Sylvanus Thayer Statue · 1 min walk
- 4.** Douglas MacArthur Monument · 3 min walk
- 5.** Sedgwick's Lucky Spurs · 6 min walk
- 6.** Ulysses S. Grant Statue · 1 min walk
- 7.** The Great Chain · 4 min walk
- 8.** Battle Monument & the Hidden Prize · 3 min walk
- 9.** The Million-Dollar View · 1 min walk

BEFORE YOU GO

- West Point is an active Army post. Check the current visitor access rules on westpoint.edu before you go, and bring photo ID for every adult. Please keep voices down near barracks and academic buildings when classes are in session. Park at Eisenhower Hall. Both routes end at Trophy Point, a short walk back to the car.
- Bring a phone with a compass app, water, and something to write with.

STARTING POINT

Eisenhower Hall

Welcome, cadets! Your mission: follow the clues across West Point. At each stop, do the activity, answer the challenge, and learn something new. Grown-ups: tap the map links or scan the QR code to get walking directions.



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

At Eisenhower Hall? Turn the page for your first clue!

CLUE 1 OF 9

*Up the hill where the oldest cadets go to chill,
big iron friends sit perfectly still.
They used to go BOOM, now they just stay.
Find the cannons and pick your favorite
today!*



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Head up the hill to the east from Eisenhower Hall toward the First Class Club. The cannons are on the lawn nearby. About 4 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

STOP 1: YOU FOUND

Cannons by the Firstie Club

ACTIVITY

Find the compass near the cannons. Which direction do the cannons point? Everybody point that way and shout it out! Then count the cannons and pick the biggest and the smallest.

CHALLENGE QUESTION

What is a “Firstie”?

Answer: A senior! West Point seniors are called First Class cadets, or “Firsties.” The First Class Club is their hangout.

FUN FACTS

- West Point has its own names for each class year: freshmen are Plebes, sophomores are Yearlings, juniors are Cows, and seniors are Firsties.
- Juniors are called “Cows” because long ago they finally got to go home on leave after two years away, “when the cows come home.”
- Captured cannons have been displayed at West Point since the Revolutionary War. The first ones were taken from the British at the Battles of Saratoga in 1777.

CLUE 2 OF 9

*Army's big rival sails out on the sea.
Go under the road for a cheer, one, two,
three!
Every Army win is painted on the wall.
Find the tunnel and give it your loudest call!*



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: From the cannons, take the path south. It dips down and goes under Washington Road through the tunnel. About 3 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

STOP 2: YOU FOUND

Beat Navy Tunnel

ACTIVITY

Count how many years are painted on the walls. Then everybody yell “BEAT NAVY!” at the same time and listen for the echo.

CHALLENGE QUESTION

In what year did Army and Navy play their very first football game?

Answer: 1890, right here at West Point. Navy won that first game, so Army has been trying to beat Navy ever since!

FUN FACTS

- The Army–Navy Game is one of the oldest rivalries in college football. It is played every December.
- During the week before the game, cadets everywhere say “Beat Navy!” instead of hello.
- Army, Navy, and Air Force compete for the Commander-in-Chief’s Trophy. The President presents it to the winner.

Who made cadets do homework BEFORE class each day?

The Father of West Point, who still stands here today.

Pop out of the tunnel and climb up the stair.

A man made of bronze is waiting right there!



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Come out of the tunnel and up the stairs. Thayer's statue is just ahead, across from the Commandant's house. About 1 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

STOP 3: YOU FOUND

Sylvanus Thayer Statue

ACTIVITY

Count the buttons on Colonel Thayer's coat. Then try the Thayer Method: each kid teaches everyone else one thing they learned today.

CHALLENGE QUESTION

Thayer already had a college degree when he came to West Point. How long did it take him to graduate?

Answer: About one year! He graduated from Dartmouth College in 1807, then from West Point in 1808.

FUN FACTS

- Thayer was Superintendent (the boss of West Point) from 1817 to 1833. He is called the "Father of the Military Academy."
- His idea was for cadets to study before class, then solve problems at the chalkboard in small groups. West Point still teaches this way, and it's called the Thayer Method.
- West Point was the first engineering school in America. Its graduates helped build many of the country's early roads, bridges, and railroads.
- Every year at graduation, the oldest living West Point graduate lays a wreath at this statue.

CLUE 4 OF 9

*A five-star general who loved a corncob pipe,
gave a famous speech, and it wasn't just
hype.*

Head to the barracks that carry his name.

Stone walls nearby are carved with his fame!



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Walk south on the path toward the big stone barracks. The statue and its plaza are at the north end of MacArthur Barracks, across the street from the Superintendent's house. About 3 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

STOP 4: YOU FOUND

Douglas MacArthur Monument

ACTIVITY

Who can pose exactly like MacArthur? Take a photo of everyone doing their best MacArthur. Then race to find the words “Duty, Honor, Country” carved in the stone walls.

CHALLENGE QUESTION

What three words are West Point's motto?

Answer: Duty, Honor, Country. They're carved right here, from MacArthur's famous 1962 speech to the cadets.

FUN FACTS

- MacArthur graduated first in his class in 1903. Later he came back to be West Point's Superintendent.
- He and his father, Arthur MacArthur, both earned the Medal of Honor. They were the first father and son to do it.
- He was a five-star General of the Army. That's the highest rank there is, and only five Army generals have ever held it.
- His wife, Jean, dedicated this statue in 1969.

*Need a little luck before a big test?
Spin a general's spurs. Cadets say it works
best!*

*Follow the Plain's edge to where "Uncle
John" stands,
and give his boot wheels a spin with your
hands.*



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Walk east along the north edge of the Plain, past the Superintendent's house, toward Trophy Point. Sedgwick stands near Washington Road. About 6 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

STOP 5: YOU FOUND

Sedgwick's Lucky Spurs

ACTIVITY

Find the spurs on Sedgwick's boots. Do they really spin?
Give them a gentle spin and make a wish for your next test.

CHALLENGE QUESTION

Why do cadets spin Sedgwick's spurs?

Answer: For luck! Legend says a cadet about to fail should spin the spurs at midnight before the final exam, wearing full dress uniform, and they'll pass.

FUN FACTS

- General John Sedgwick's soldiers loved him so much they called him "Uncle John." They paid for this statue themselves in 1868.
- He was the highest-ranking Union officer killed in the Civil War, at the Battle of Spotsylvania in 1864.
- In 2024 the statue was cleaned and the spurs were repaired so they would keep spinning, a gift from the West Point Class of 1978.

CLUE 6 OF 9

*His real name was Hiram, but a mix-up, oh my,
made him “U.S. Grant,” so friends called him
“Sam.” That’s why!
He won the Civil War, then was President
too.
The Plain’s newest statue is waiting for you!*



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Grant stands a few steps away at the corner of the Plain near Thayer Road, across from Battle Monument. About 1 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

STOP 6: YOU FOUND

Ulysses S. Grant Statue

ACTIVITY

Grant is holding two things. What are they? Then, out on the grass, everyone gallop like a horse and leap over a pretend high-jump bar.

CHALLENGE QUESTION

Grant was the best horse rider in his class. What record did he set as a cadet?

Answer: A high-jump record on his horse, York. It lasted about 25 years!

FUN FACTS

- Grant was born Hiram Ulysses Grant. The congressman who sent him to West Point wrote his name as “Ulysses S. Grant” by mistake, and the name stuck.
- Because his initials were U.S., his classmates nicknamed him “Uncle Sam,” or just “Sam.”
- He graduated in 1843 and became the first West Point graduate to be President of the United States.
- This statue was added in 2019. He's holding riding gloves, a nod to his horse skills, and a sword.

*To stop British ships from sailing upriver,
they stretched something across that would
make captains shiver.*

*Each link weighs as much as a grown-up,
maybe more!*

Find the giant chain near the river's shore.



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Cross the road carefully and head northeast across Trophy Point toward the river. The chain links are on the east end. About 4 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

STOP 7: YOU FOUND

The Great Chain

ACTIVITY

Measure one link with your hands. How many hands long is it? Then lie down next to the chain: how many kids long is the whole thing?

CHALLENGE QUESTION

The chain was made of heavy iron. How did it stay on top of the water?

Answer: It was attached to big floating logs, like rafts, all the way across the river.

FUN FACTS

- In 1778, soldiers stretched the Great Chain across the Hudson River from West Point to Constitution Island. That's the island you can see across the water.
- Each link is about 2 feet long and weighs over 100 pounds. The whole chain was about a third of a mile long.
- It was taken out every winter so the river ice wouldn't wreck it, then put back every spring.
- The British never tried to break through it.

*A super-tall column as smooth as can be,
with a winged lady on top for all to see.
Big stone balls and old cannons stand guard
on the ground.
Peek inside the cannons. Is there treasure to
be found?*



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: Walk back west across Trophy Point to the tall column.
About 3 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

Battle Monument & the Hidden Prize

ACTIVITY

Peek inside the cannons around the monument. Did somebody leave a prize? Then take a picture with the big granite balls. Can your family link arms all the way around one? Look up: who can see the statue on the very top?

CHALLENGE QUESTION

The statue on top is named after a word that means being very well known. What's her name?

Answer: Fame! She was sculpted by Frederick MacMonnies.

FUN FACTS

- The column is 46 feet tall and made of one polished piece of granite. It's believed to be one of the largest polished granite columns in the Western Hemisphere.
- It honors the 2,230 Regular Army soldiers and officers who died for the Union in the Civil War. Their names are carved here.
- Soldiers paid for it by giving a little bit of their pay. It was dedicated in 1897.

Grown-up tip: Want a prize moment? Before you start, hide a small treat in the mouth of one of the cannons here and tell the kids to check inside.

CLUE 9 OF 9

You made it to the end, and the view is the prize!

Find the big grassy hill that will open your eyes.

Look north up the river past mountains so grand.

It's the million-dollar view, the best in the land!



[Google Maps](#) | [Apple Maps](#)

Scan or tap for walking directions

Grown-ups: From Battle Monument, walk to the top of the grassy hill and look north up the river. About 1 min.

Found it? Turn the page!

STOP 9: YOU FOUND

The Million-Dollar View

ACTIVITY

BONUS ROUND! (1) Take a drink from the water fountain below Battle Monument. (2) Roll or run down the hill, but be careful, it's steeper than it looks! (3) Take a family photo with the million-dollar view. Last of all, everyone shares their favorite stop.

CHALLENGE QUESTION

Looking up the river, what is the big mountain on the left?

Answer: Storm King Mountain. Across the river on the right is Breakneck Ridge.

FUN FACTS

- Trophy Point is named for the captured cannons, or “trophies,” displayed here. They come from five different wars.
- Painters from the Hudson River School, a famous group of American artists in the 1800s, came here to paint this view.
- In the summer, the West Point Band plays concerts in the amphitheater below the hill.



Mission complete!

You finished the Short Route: 9 stops and about 0.9 miles.
Every cadet earns an honorary Black Knight salute. Hooah!